Mentoring Coordinator Interview - 2026 10 20 15 13 PST - Recording 2

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[Aldrin]
One of the groupmates of M, I will be asking the questions. So for our first question, could you briefly tell us about your role as a mentoring coordinator and whether are you a mentor yourself?

[Sir Lactao (SSE Mentoring Coordinator)]
Okay, so Aldrin, I am a coordinator for the School of Education and I'm also a mentor. What I do is that I try to pair students who are in their second year up, I think. So I try to look into the previous year's mentoring preparing and then try to ask the students.

So I have a list of mentorment preparing last year, then I send an email to the students if they still want to keep their mentors and then there are some students who are not paired with their mentors. So I try to look into the different mentors and I email them asking them if they have this list of mentees and if they're willing to take on more mentees. So if they say yes, then I'll try to add more mentees to their list, to their initial list.

And if we still lack mentees, I actually ask the help of the Office of Student Mentoring to help me also because sometimes the students request for a different mentor, so we change them. Also, I also did a survey. I did a survey, I made Google Forms among our students and I asked them if they want to keep their mentors and if not, I gave them a list of mentors and then choose mentors if they want to change mentors.

But since not many students do that, so at least if those students who answer that survey, I already paired them with their mentor, previous mentor if they chose their previous mentor or to a new mentor of their choice depending on the availability of that mentor. So that's the tricky part. They might choose a particular mentor but also I am not sure if the mentor is available to take in more mentees.

So that's also one of the things that we do. Okay, so once the pairings are done, I send the list to... Wait, sorry.

Once the pairings are done, I have a database of all the mentors and mentees. I then send an email to the mentors of the mentees that they have. So if they're okay with their mentees, then okay, we proceed.

And then I ask them also if they're willing to take in more mentees if there are still mentees without mentors. And then it's the Office of Student Mentoring who will email the students of their mentees. So on my end, I email the mentors of the list of their mentees and then OSM will email the students regarding their assigned mentor.

Now, another difficulty we have is that if they don't answer the survey, we will have emails like, Sir, can I change my mentor or Sir, can I retain my mentor if, let's say, in my experience, the list that I received from last year is not the actual mentor-mentee pairings. So there are a lot of problems. So I have to refine that because the list wasn't saved.

I wasn't given the actual mentor-mentee pairings. I have to make some guesses. So that's the flow.

So once I have emailed the mentor, then they will tell me, I can take in more mentees, then I email them the mentees. Or the mentees will also tell us, Sir, can I change my mentor? Then we change the mentee.

So that's how the process is.

[Aldrin]
So from what I understood, you manage the mentors, then you assign the mentee-mentor pairing. Yes, that's right. And then, is there a slight difference between the methods with the other coordinator we interviewed?

What I got was that you email the mentees if they want to retain their mentor.

[Sir Lactao (SSE Mentoring Coordinator)]
Is that right? Yes. I sent a G-form to all the students under my school.

I sent them a G-form asking them if they want to retain their mentor. It's like an initial survey. But the thing there is that very few students answered.

Maybe only 10% to 20% answered.

[Aldrin]
How long have you been a mentor?

[Sir Lactao (SSE Mentoring Coordinator)]
I mean a mentoring coordinator. Well, just now, I volunteered to be the coordinator because our admin assistant has her hands full with other things. Since I'm familiar with mentoring, since I used to head the Office of Student Mentoring before, I took on that task.

[Aldrin]
As a mentor, how many mentees do you have?

[Sir Lactao (SSE Mentoring Coordinator)]
Now? Maybe 20 to 30.

[Aldrin]
Does it vary per mentor? What's the average?

[Sir Lactao (SSE Mentoring Coordinator)]
Yes, it varies. Some mentors, they have around 2, 3, 5. Some mentors have 10, 20, 30 mentees.

40 or 50 even at times.

[Aldrin]
So, is it mostly based on the schedule or availability of the mentor?

[Sir Lactao (SSE Mentoring Coordinator)]

The pairing? No, the number. The willingness of the mentor to take in more mentees.

So, some mentors say that they can only take in 5 or they can take in more. So, it depends on the mentor. I don't know if it's availability.

But for me, for example, if students choose me, it's going to be… I accept it because my impression is the students will initiate the mentoring so I don't have to run after them. So, it's easier for me to understand.

Because, of course, considering the tasks that I have to do, it's more efficient that they are willing to mentor. Because they will send an email and no one will reply or it will take time to reply. Although I do that also at the beginning of the semester and then the middle of the semester before.

But now, students are required to have mentoring. So, I guess that will solve that problem of mine.

[Aldrin]
I'll just ask this. Why did you take part in this mentoring program?

[Sir Lactao (SSE Mentoring Coordinator)]
The mentoring program? Well, actually, before going to the university, I was already familiar with mentoring. I was like a mentoring coordinator in a previous work.

It's in a school also. It's a part of school, part of Northfield School. So, there's a mentoring program there and I really like the experience of mentoring.

And then when I moved into UANP, I actually became the head of the mentoring desk. So, there's the mentoring desk. I think on my second year, I became head of the mentoring desk already in UANP.

So, I've been with UANP for 15 years now. So, it's been that long.

[Aldrin]
What do you personally want the mentoring program to achieve for its students?

[Sir Lactao (SSE Mentoring Coordinator)]
Maybe that the students will be able to have a seamless mentor-mentee pairing. There is coordination so that it's a smooth experience for those making the pairing. And then also for the student, for the mentees and the mentors also.

On the side.

[Em]
I'm sorry. Go ahead.

[Sir Lactao (SSE Mentoring Coordinator)]
It's just a smooth process. At the moment, the hitches here is that the mentor doesn't reply, for example. Or the student will reply late.

They want this mentor but he didn't reply before. But I need to send the list, right? So, there are such hitches that can be resolved along the way.

The problem is, of course, for my case, I'm just doing this now. I was hoping that I won't be doing this next year because I have administrative tasks then that was given to me.

[Aldrin]
I'll just ask. Is there a matching criteria when coming up with the pairings of the mentor and mentees?

[Sir Lactao (SSE Mentoring Coordinator)]
Actually, the only criteria I have is the preference of the mentees. Because I think it would be half the battle if the mentees choose their mentors. If the mentee didn't choose their mentor, then I will pair them to the mentors willing to take in more mentees.

So, if the mentors are willing to take in more mentees, then I put them there.

[Aldrin]
So, moving on. Could you walk us through a typical semester of mentoring in the school? Before the policy.

[Sir Lactao (SSE Mentoring Coordinator)]
My personal mentoring? Yes. So, I wasn't a mentoring coordinator before so I was just like a regular mentor.

I received an email from mentoring coordinators from different schools. So, I have a lot of mentees because I have them in my school. Management, School of Science and Engineering.

That's M, my mentee. So, I received several emails asking me if I am willing to take in their mentees. When I moved into the School of Education, I already limited the number of mentees to those who would choose me.

So, if they ask me, can I add more mentees to you? I tell them, no, I won't add more mentees because there are a lot of unpaired mentees in the School of Education. So, I might as well pair myself with the students in the School of Education.

Then, once I mentioned that these are my mentees, then I'm given a list. Once I'm given a list, I send an individual email to them. But I have a template.

I'm your mentor for this year. These are the expectations that I have of mentoring. Usually, set goals.

And then, I wait for them to reply. If they reply, then we have initial contact. Once we have initial contact, we try to get other ways to communicate like messenger.

Usually, it's messenger so that it's easier to communicate. We can have a mentoring schedule through messenger or viber. But usually, it's messenger or email.

And then, through that, this is before the policy, then we set mentoring. Now, before I would initiate a mentoring, yes. I would initiate mentoring.

But now, I don't have much time. So, it's the mentee who would send me an email, Sir, can we talk? And then, we have a conversation.

We talk about various things. Of course, I try to get to know them to see how they can benefit from mentoring. To see points where they can improve on.

So, I look into different aspects of the person. And that's why I ask them, of course, about their academic goals. Because, of course, it's an academic institution.

So, I make sure that at least they're concerned about their studies. And that they're doing their best. I also ask them about personal goals.

What do you want to improve on as a person? But of course, it could also include academic goals. Let's say, I don't want to be lazy.

So, maybe study habits. So, those are the things that we talk about. Of course, we talk about things that they want to talk about also.

Like, their favorite food. Their favorite restaurant. Their hobby sports.

So, we talk about those things also. Then, after that, we set another appointment. I have mentees I meet every week before.

Or every two weeks. Or every month. So, that's usually the frequency.

Or every so often. So, that's the mentoring. Now, usually also before, at the end of the semester, I try to meet them also.

Just to wrap up what we were discussing during that semester. But, of course, sometimes the kids are also busy. I'm also busy.

I also don't set the end of semester. End of school year mentoring. So, that's more or less how it goes.

At least for me. So, now, the students are the ones more active in reaching out to me. But, I noticed that the new students are the ones who reach out.

Because, of course, the old students, maybe, maybe not. Because, of course, if you're a new student, you're more cognizant of the new policies, right? Because you didn't know what it was not before, right?

And since the older students now, well, I have a few who reach out. But, mostly, the new students are the ones reaching out to have mentoring. Sometimes, if I see my mentee, I say, Hey, we need to have mentoring.

That's a requirement. Because you might not be able to enroll next semester. So, they reach out.

But, not all of them do.

[Aldrin]
So, how do you do your mentoring? Earlier, you gave me the list of enrollees.

[Sir Lactao (SSE Mentoring Coordinator)]
For example, our student, as a coordinator, I ask the list from registrar. Because they already have the list of students. I ask for, you don't need a name.

Name, email, course, year level. Because this information is needed for the mentors. So, when I send an email to the mentor, they know what year, they know what course, and they know the email, at least the official email address.

So, the mentors can contact them also. So, I get it from the registrar's office. Or the official list of students.

[Aldrin]
How long is the process usually? Are there delays or whatever?

[Sir Lactao (SSE Mentoring Coordinator)]
Ah, because I'm friends with the registrar. I also know Bobby. So, it's just fast.

They didn't take long to send it to me. I don't remember waiting too long. Maybe less than 3 days.

Maybe 2 to 3 days.

[Aldrin]
I'm not sure if I'm allowed to share this, but according to the other mentor that we interviewed as well, they have trouble with the registrar because it's a bit slow to release, especially the incoming new students. That's where they usually get delayed.

[Sir Lactao (SSE Mentoring Coordinator)]
Ah, incoming new students. Ah, wait. Okay, it's like this.

It's just fast because we were also a bit late to release our list of mentees. Maybe by that time, the new students are already there. Maybe that's why the registrar is getting delayed because they're waiting for the students to enroll.

In my case, I was also a bit late to email them. So, maybe that's why it's fast because the data is already available. So, usually around September-ish, the list of pairings is already done.

I think around September. I think it's already September.

[Aldrin]
So, when a student asks for a mentor change, what usually happens on your side as the coordinator?

[Sir Lactao (SSE Mentoring Coordinator)]

So, if they want for a mentor change, I will ask them if they have a preferred mentor. If they have a preferred mentor, then I will ask the mentor if they're willing to accept this new mentee. If they don't have a preferred mentor, I give them a list of possible mentors that they can get.

And then I ask the mentor if they're okay. If the mentor is not okay, then I have to look for another mentor. But usually, it's not that difficult to transfer them.

Once there's a mentor who agrees, then I send an updated list of mentees copying Ms. Nina or the Office of Student Mentoring so that they know that there's an updated list. Then, I think I also email the student telling them, okay, you have a new mentor.

[Aldrin]
Additional question. Do you think there are shortages in the mentors that are available per school?

[Sir Lactao (SSE Mentoring Coordinator)]
Yes, because there are only a few mentors. So, we need more mentors, actually. Other mentors have a lot of mentees.

So, now that mentoring is required, I think, I foresee that at the end of the semester, the mentors of the mentees will increase because they won't be able to get involved unless they get mentored.

[Aldrin]
In your opinion, what are the criteria for being a mentor? For example, I'm a teacher in this school. What are the criteria for being a mentor?

If I'm part-time, can I be a mentor as well or full-time?

[Sir Lactao (SSE Mentoring Coordinator)]
For part-time mentors, they can also be mentors. They're usually recommended. There's also a scorecard that they use.

I remember when I was still with CSA, we developed a scorecard so that we can propose someone to be a mentor. So, there are criteria for that. I don't remember the criteria now.

So, there should be someone who will vouch for him from someone who is familiar with an external mentor and with someone who works inside the university. So, if they're alumni, it's okay. It's easier because we know the mentor.

So, it's easier for him to process. Professors are usually recommended by their supervisors. So, there are criteria for that.

For example, there's a certain professor who can be a mentor. He will be recommended by his supervisor to the Ofcom. And then the Ofcom will send the list, I think, to the Office of Student Mentoring.

Student Mentoring then gives a list to the Mancom. The Mancom approves the list of mentors.

[Aldrin]
So, currently, what are your current frustrations within the program?

[Sir Lactao (SSE Mentoring Coordinator)]
It's hard. There are mentors who don't reply. Or there are students who reply late.

So, it's hard for them to pair. Then we have to release the list. Then the mentor or mentee still hasn't replied.

I appreciate that the Office of Student Mentoring helps me. The Office of Student Mentoring is a big help. So, I think that's what I'm thinking right now.

[Aldrin]
So, how do you find out if a mentee is doing well?

[Sir Lactao (SSE Mentoring Coordinator)]
As a mentor?

[Aldrin]
Yes.

[Sir Lactao (SSE Mentoring Coordinator)]
I ask them in our mentoring chats how they are. Usually, they tell me if they're doing well, if they're doing okay. So, I ask them various questions.

So, I know that they're doing well if they tell me that, okay, they're able to achieve their goals. Also, if they're challenged enough. Although, I don't think I have a problem with challenging the mentees.

They have certain goals. They try to do that. What was the other question?

How will I know if a mentee is doing well?

[Aldrin]
Can I rephrase the question?

[Sir Lactao (SSE Mentoring Coordinator)]
Okay, sure.

[Aldrin]
Is there a success criteria when it comes to mentoring a student? How do you know if you successfully mentored this specific student?

[Sir Lactao (SSE Mentoring Coordinator)]
Actually, it's a good question to ask if you successfully mentored a student.

[Aldrin]
So, it's mostly in your feedback survey?

[Sir Lactao (SSE Mentoring Coordinator)]

Yes, of the students. But for me, if the child is able to achieve their goals, or I think the mere fact that they reach out to me and ask me for my opinion, I guess it's already successful the mere fact that they reach out. So, it means they find some value in mentoring.

Otherwise, they will not be reaching out for that. Another criteria is if they themselves become mentors eventually. But of course, it's still a long way to go.

[Aldrin]
So far, that's all the questions I have right now. M, do you have other questions? Maybe, sir.

[Sir Lactao (SSE Mentoring Coordinator)]
What does holistically developed mean to you? For me, I look into the different aspects of a person, especially the concern of the mentee, and ask them about it, how they're doing, what they think about it. And then, it also means that all of these, even their different facets, they influence also the other aspects.

So, it's not compartmentalized into silos, but these are different aspects that influence all the others also. So, we have to consider that as a whole person. So, even let's say one aspect, academic life, it actually could spill over one's spiritual life or one's psychosocial development.

So, it's related. So, that's what I mean by holistic, that even just one aspect, it influences the entire person, the entire being.

[Aldrin]
Do you have another one? I just want to confirm something. So, in mentoring, there's only three or four actors, right?

So, we have the OSM, and then the mentoring coordinator per school, then we have the mentors, and then the students. Then externally, we have the registrar because that's where you get the list of students. So, other than that, there's no other school body or other unit.

[Sir Lactao (SSE Mentoring Coordinator)]
That's all, I think. Okay. Thank you, sir.

I'm sure this will be relevant. Of course, knowledge about the guidance office, so that if you have mentees that we think would need guidance support, then we refer them to the guidance office. So, that's how it is.

I mean, maybe other support also, right? So, if they want to drop, then we refer them to the registrar's office. Okay.

[Aldrin]
So far, those are my questions. Thank you, sir. That's the same as well for me.

[Sir Lactao (SSE Mentoring Coordinator)]
Thank you, sir. Okay. Thank you very much, and good luck with your project.

Thank you for taking this on.

[Aldrin]
Thank you.

[Sir Lactao (SSE Mentoring Coordinator)]
Good luck, sir. Thank you, sir. Thank you.

[Aldrin]
Sir, on another note, can we schedule another mentoring session next week?

[Sir Lactao (SSE Mentoring Coordinator)]
Sure. We already had a mentoring session, right? Okay.

You can send a message to the messenger next week. Okay. Let me know what days you're available.

Usually, I'm free in the morning and on Wednesdays. But since I don't have my calendar, I can't access my calendar now. Okay.

Let's send a message. Thank you, sir. Okay.

[Em]
Thank you, sir.

[Sir Lactao (SSE Mentoring Coordinator)]
Thank you. Bye, sir.

[Em]
Bye-bye.
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